Project Report

Digital Literacy

Course Code: CSE0001

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Introduction

In today's interconnected world, digital literacy is no longer just an advantage it is a fundamental requirement. As a selected Student Digital Ambassador my role in this project was to guide my peers in navigating the digital landscape safely and professionally. This project portfolio serves as a guide and a personal reflection on essential digital skills throughout this project. I have completed five tasks from the five modules constituting the course. This report documents my journey through thee tasks highlighting the tools I used, the challenges I overcame and the valuable insights I gained to foster a safer and more productive digital environment for our academic community.

Task 1 Write-up

For the task, I used Canva to design the infographic as it provided a versatile platform to balance technical information with a clean, modern aesthetic

The design is structured into three distinct panels to ensure high readability and flow of information

The first section, What is Digital Literacy, establishes a foundation by defining the concept as a blend of technical ability and critical thinking.

The middle panel, Useful Digital Tools, highlights productivity enhancing software such as cloud storage and collaborative platforms for modern students.

The final section, Safe Internet Practices provides actionable security advice, focusing on password strength and recognizing phishing attempts to ensure a secure online experience.

One thing I found particularly interesting during the design process was the challenge of visual economy. It was difficult to condense complex cybersecurity and literacy concepts into short, high impactful sentences that fit within the grid layout.

Task 2 Write-up

For this task, I selected LinkedIn, Kaggle and Stack Overflow as my foundational platforms.

LinkedIn serves as a professional platform for networking and tracking industry trends.

Kaggle is a comprehensive platform for data science and machine leaning enthusiasts offering tools, resources, and a vibrant community to learn, collaborate and solve real-world problems.

Stack Overflow is a popular question-and-answer website specifically designed for computer programmers.

Over the next four years of my engineering degree, I plan to use these platforms to document my academic growth at VIT Bhopal. My LinkedIn profile will evolve alongside my academic milestones, serving as a platform to connect with industry mentors and showcase my certifications, I intend to use Kaggle to participate in community challenges to refine my problem-solving skills.

Task 3 Write-up

For the third module of the project, I used HackerRank and Google Forms to improve my technical and collaborative skills. On HackerRank, I focused on Python, successfully completing the "Python Introduction" challenges. This practice allowed me to practice my syntax and logical structuring, which are essential to my studies. And then, I developed a five-question "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms.

Academically, these platforms are very helpful. HackerRank provides a structured environment to prepare for technical interviews and competitive programming, making me practice the algorithmic concepts taught in my computer science modules. Meanwhile, learning to use Google Workspace tools like Forms and Sheets simplifies data collection for research projects and laboratory reports.

Task 4 Write-up

In an academic situation, a common instance of poor digital communication occurs when students send brief, informal messages to faculty via email or Microsoft Teams. For example, a student once sent a message to a professor that simply read "need more time for the lab report," lacking a subject line, formal greeting, or explanation. The professor misinterpreted this bluntness as a lack of respect and entitlement, leading to a strained relationship and the initial denial of the extension request.

To avoid this, the student should have followed professional etiquette by including a clear subject line and a respectful salutation. Instead of a demanding tone

Task 5 Write-up

What surprised me the most was while researching UPI "Collect Request" fraud how easily social engineering can cause security concerns and the psychological manipulation involved, attackers don't just use technical exploits, they involve "urgency" and the victim’s eagerness to receive payment to cloud their judgment. Discovering that a simple "Receive" button can be masked as a "Pay" request tricking even tech students into entering their PIN—highlighted a significant gap between digital access and true digital literacy.

As a direct result of this research, I am personally changing my habit of "speed running" digital transactions. I have committed to a "Pause and Read" rule before entering my UPI PIN for any transaction.

Conclusion

This project has been a practical and eye opening experience. It bridged the gap between knowledge of the digital world and hands on application. From designing visual content and establishing a professional coding portfolio to understanding the problems of digital communication and cyber threats, I feel more ready to act as a Student Digital Ambassador. This knowledge and skills will form the foundation of my professional journey in technology.

References

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NPCI : npci.org.in/upi-safety